



"The new BJP leader will be from outside Delhi"

Photographs by HEMANT CHAWLA/www.indiatodayimages.com

end Hindu-Muslim fighting. A mosque can't be constructed at the same site. Let them construct another mosque at some other place and the Hindus will extend all possible help.

Q. The Congress apologised for the anti-Sikh riots and Advani said the demolition was a national shame.

A. The Sangh did not say "demolish the structure" but the court's delay on the verdict angered the people.

Q. Do you agree with Advani that it was a national shame?

A. I don't agree with Advani on this issue. Why didn't they give legal permission for *kar seva* when so many people had collected for it?

Q. Why is the Sangh unwilling to do something which makes minori-

ties feel safe? Whatever happened in Gujarat also added to the gap between the Sangh and the minorities.

A. Violence is wrong wherever it happens. Don't just look at one side. What happened in Godhra should not have happened. No one talks about the killings at Godhra.

Q. Should Narendra Modi apolo-

"I don't agree with Advani that Babri was a national shame. Hindus will help them construct a mosque at another place."

gise for the Gujarat carnage?

A. He is the head of a state, he has full knowledge of what happened and is capable of giving his reaction. If he thinks that something that needs an apology has taken place, then he will apologise. I am sure. I have also been told the speed with which the riots in Gujarat were controlled is commendable. Why should he apologise if he has done no wrong? That is not the way.

Q. Sonia Gandhi and Manmohan Singh were not responsible for the 1984 riots but have apologised. It increases their stature. If Modi or the RSS do the same, they will stand to gain.

A. At that time there was a comment, 'When a big tree falls, some things are bound to happen.' No such statement was made in Gujarat.

Q. Does it mean the RSS will never compromise on its core issues?

A. India's unity and integrity is non-negotiable. So is the Ram Mandir at Ayodhya and a Uniform Civil Code.

Q. If I understand correctly, you still believe in Akhand Bharat and not in the two-nation theory.

A. It is all part of India. Pakistan is transitory and will become part of India sooner or later.

Q. What about Afghanistan?

A. Pakistan and Afghanistan are a part of us and will return one day.

Q. You claim that the RSS has no direct control over the BJP. But it sent 35 pracharaks to the BJP and they report to you.

A. It is not compulsory that they report to us. We only want them to stick to their principles. We don't interfere in their work.

Q. There have been reports of RSS pressure on the BJP, that Vasundhara Raje was removed because of pressure from the RSS.

A. The RSS had nothing to do with it. This is an internal matter of the BJP.

Q. Four months ago you talked about a change in the BJP leadership. The BJP lost three state elections and no change seems forthcoming.

A. Change will happen but at its own time. I only said what I have been told (by the BJP), they have a plan in mind and it is rolling on.

Q. There is a strong feeling that